

Bài tập thực hành 4

The role of the modern zoo

Initially seen purely as centres of entertainment, zoos were often heavily criticised in society for keeping animals captive. Nowadays, however, zoos have a lot more to offer than perhaps some people realise. Good zoos have changed their focus and are now responding to environmental problems, such as the decline in wildlife and loss of habitat. Indeed, scientists believe that a third of all animal and plant species on Earth risk extinction within this century.

The modern zoo, therefore, has developed dramatically as a major force in conserving biodiversity* worldwide. Zoos linked with the Association of Zoos and Aquariums participate in Species Survival Plan Programmes, which involve captive breeding, reintroduction programmes and public education to ensure the survival of many of the planet's threatened and endangered species. Captive breeding is the process of breeding animals outside their natural environment in restricted conditions such as farms, zoos or other closed areas. It is a method used to increase the populations of endangered species, in order to prevent extinction. One of the main challenges facing captive breeding programmes, however, is maintaining genetic diversity.* Zoo staff are fully trained in this area, and manage the programmes carefully to ensure genetic variation.

Another way in which zoos protect endangered species is through reintroduction programmes. These programmes release animals that have been in the zoo back into their natural habitats.

Finally, and perhaps most significantly, many zoos now concentrate on educating the public, particularly the younger generation. These zoos educate millions of visitors each year about endangered species and related conservation issues. Visiting the zoo not only raises money for conservation projects, but also reminds individuals about environmental issues.

**biodiversity - the number and types of plants and animals that exist in a particular area, or in the world generally.*

**genetic diversity - the variety of genes within a species*

Read the text and look at the statements and write

YES if the statement agrees with the views or claims of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the view of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks

Zoos have been very successful in protecting endangered species.	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
Putting endangered animals back into the wild to	• A. Yes

reproduce is a good way to increase their populations.	• B. No • C. Not Given
All zoos now focus on teaching people about animals facing extinction.	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
Zoo visits increase awareness of environmental problems.	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given

PREP.VN